

Samane Afshari

Eugene, Oregon

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Professional Summary

Ph.D. student in Planning and Public Affairs with years of experience in urban research and public sector. Specialized in urban competitiveness, international benchmarking, and sustainable development strategies. Currently seeking opportunities to contribute to city planning or policy research in the U.S. public sector.

Education

University of Oregon, Eugene, OR

Ph.D. student in Planning and Public Affairs —September 2024 to present

- Graduate Teaching Fellow and Research Assistant
- Focus: Urban climate governance

University of Tehran – Faculty of World Studies, Tehran, Iran

M.A. in European Studies (British Studies – Urban Focus) — Feb 2012

- Thesis: Global City of London: Competitive Advantage(s) within Financial Globalization

University of Qom, Qom, Iran

B.A. in English Language and Literature — June 2009

Professional Experience

University of Oregon, Eugene, OR

Graduate Teaching Fellow and Research Assistant — Sep 2024–Present

- Support instructors for the courses of ‘green cities’, ‘Introduction to City Planning’ and ‘Introduction to Public Policy’, Climate change policy, Environmental management.
- Assist in conducting scholarly research on localization of the UN SDGs

Iwan Mehr Iranian Engineering Consultants Company, Tehran, Iran

Urban Policy Researcher & Consultant — 2015–2024

- Led Iran’s urban competitiveness project in partnership with the Global Urban Competitiveness Project, covering 10 metropolitan areas
- Participated in the EU-funded URBiNAT Project on nature-based urban regeneration and participatory design

- Provided strategic policy recommendations for improving Tehran's performance on national and international urban indices

University of Tehran – Faculty of World Studies, Tehran, Iran

Teaching Assistant & Research Associate — Jan 2010–Nov 2014

- Supported graduate courses on the UK Economy and the Welfare State
- Contributed to the World Economic Forum–supervised national project on Iran's global competitiveness strategy

Freelance Translator, Remote

English–Persian Translator — Feb 2004–Jan 2010

Selected Publications

Afshari, S. (2018). Assessing Competitiveness of Tehran in National and International Rankings. Research and Planning Center of Tehran Municipality.

Afshari, S. & Akhoundi, S. (Translators) (2018). Planning and Decentralization: Contested Spaces for Public Action in the Global South. Agah Publication.

Afshari, S. (2016). Urban Competitiveness: Assessment of Metropolitan Cities in Iran. Council of Urban Planning and Architecture.

Research Focus

- Urban climate governance
- Governance & Sustainability

Proficient in

Nvivo

Basics in R

